

Sa'ood Williams

Full-Stack Developer — Next.js · React · TypeScript · Node.js

Cape Town, South Africa · Remote (GMT+2 — overlaps EMEA & US-East) · +27 68 285 7689

saoodwilliams321@gmail.com · github.com/CACTUSCASH · cipher30mentorship.com

SUMMARY

Self-taught full-stack developer who ships production web apps end to end in Next.js, React and TypeScript — and runs the Linux hosting, CI/CD and support underneath them. For two years I have built and operated a live education platform solo, with no team and no supervision: proof I can own work remotely and deliver to deadline. Fully remote-ready from Cape Town, working async over Git/GitHub across EMEA and US-East hours. A Higher Certificate in Information Systems (Cyber Security) puts security and networking in the foundation, not bolted on. Looking for a remote junior-to-mid full-stack or front-end role.

KEY SKILLS

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Bash, SQL
- **Frontend:** Next.js 15 (App Router), React 19, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, responsive UI, Three.js / React Three Fiber (WebGL)
- **Backend:** Node.js, REST APIs, Prisma ORM, NextAuth, SQLite / PostgreSQL
- **DevOps & infra:** Vercel, Railway, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Cloudflare, Linux (Ubuntu), DNS / domain configuration
- **Engineering practices:** Git & GitHub (pull requests, protected branches), performance optimization, web security (OWASP), SEO / structured data, technical documentation
- **Remote & collaboration:** fully async workflow, self-managed delivery, AI-assisted engineering (Claude Code + MCP)

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Full-Stack Developer — Cipher30 · Cape Town / Remote · Jan 2024 – Present

Built and run an online-education platform end to end, solo — every line of code, deploy and support ticket is mine.

- Shipped a production Next.js 15 / TypeScript / Tailwind app on Vercel with GitHub CI/CD — custom Three.js WebGL hero, JSON-LD SEO, AVIF/WebP image pipeline and iOS safe-area handling. Live at cipher30mentorship.com.
- Diagnosed and fixed iOS Safari scroll-jank: removed a conflicting inertial-scroll library, rAF-throttled the carousel handler, and isolated a 1 Hz clock that was forcing full-tree re-renders every second — restoring smooth scrolling on mobile and desktop.
- Built a Node.js + discord.js v14 lead-capture bot on a SQLite backend (Railway): source-attributed welcome DMs, pipeline tracking, hot-lead alerts, and slash commands that grant paid-member roles on close.
- Cut a multi-hour manual video job down to minutes with a Playwright + ffmpeg pipeline — headless capture, overlay compositing and audio muxing.
- Run all hosting, domains, DNS, uptime and first-line member support; wrote the process documentation and training used by clients and the sales representative.

Freelance developer & media · Cape Town / Remote

- Delivered branding and video content for an independent fashion label, to spec and on deadline.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Full source at github.com/CACTUSCASH.

- **nextjs-security-middleware** — drop-in Next.js middleware: sliding-window rate limiting plus OWASP request scanning.
- **nextjs-cinematic-hero / shader-play** — WebGL and custom-GLSL work: a reusable cinematic hero component and a 50,000-particle GPU field with no per-frame CPU cost.
- **claude-mcp-profiler** — CLI that profiles Model Context Protocol tool calls to surface latency hotspots.
- **Security toolkit** — Python tools (port scanner, packet sniffer, DNS / subdomain enumeration, file-integrity monitor) built to learn network security hands-on.

EDUCATION

Higher Certificate in Information Systems: Cyber Security · Eduvos, Cape Town · May 2026

Modules (coursework, taught to the CompTIA syllabi): Network+, Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, CASP+, Linux Administration, Wireless Networks & Security. Distinctions in the Security+ (92%), PenTest+ (81%) and CASP+ (81%) modules.